

1 BACKGROUND

- 1.1 The minimum requirements for auditor qualification for all Forest Stewardship Council (hereinafter FSC) scopes have been defined by FSC in the document “FSC-STD-20-001 v4.0 – General Requirements for FSC accredited certification bodies”. A separate procedure “FSC-PRO-20-004 v1.1 – General Requirements for an FSC Training Program” has been created.

2 PURPOSE AND SCOPE

- 2.1 This procedure outlines the guidelines and the process by which ASI will monitor training programs developed for FSC auditors according to FSC-PRO-20-004 v1.1.
- 2.2 This procedure applies to all FSC training programs. Training programs can be delivered by both Conformity Assessment Bodies (hereinafter CAB) and external training organizations.

3 CHANGE HISTORY

Version number	Date of approval (Effective date)	Description of changes
1	03/11/2016	First publication
1.1	16/03/2018	Formatting changes; no content changes.
1.2	17 January 2019	Logo and name updated; no content changes.
1.3	15 October 2022	Minor revision to add terms “approval/approved” in line with the ASI Two-Tier Assurance Program. ASI Logo update. Change to numbers instead of bullets in definitions.

4 TERMS AND DEFINITIONS

- 4.1 All ASI terms and definitions are provided in the ASI Glossary (ASI-INF-20-100).
- 4.2 As this document applies to specific FSC processes, all terms and definitions under the FSC system are covered in the respective FSC standards and procedures.
- 4.3 **Training Program:** A framework that encompasses implementation requirements (Part 1 of FSC-PRO-20-004) and content requirements (Part 2 of FSC-PRO-20-004) for ‘FSC training’ (see Annex 2 of FSC-STD-20-001 V4-0).
- 4.4 **Training provider:** An entity that delivers part or all of the FSC Training Program. This may be an FSC-accredited/approved CAB or an external training service provider (non-CAB).
- 4.5 **Trainer:** An experienced auditor competent in auditing against FSC scopes with an additional competence in delivering the core content of the FSC Training Program.
- 4.6 **Trainee:** Any person participating in a training course.
- 4.7 **Training:** Interactive (sequence of) session(s) delivered by at least one trainer. While lecture(s) may be part of training, it is only one of a set of varied methods (e.g. discussion rounds, role plays, case studies, or individual and group work) used for the active engagement of trainees for the development, maintenance or improvement of their competence(s).

5 ASSOCIATED DOCUMENTATION

5.1	Standards and Policies	ISO 19011:2011 – Guidelines for auditing management systems FSC-STD-20-001 v4.0 – General Requirements for FSC accredited CABs
5.2	Procedures	ASI-INF-20-100-ASI Glossary ASI-INF-20-124- Fee Schedule ASI-PRO-20-101-Accreditation ASI-PRO-20-111-Witness & Compliance ASI-PRO-20-106-ASI Findings ASI-PRO-20-112-FSC–Auditor and Training Registry ASI-PRO-20-113- FSC – Auditor Registry Transition Procedure FSC-PRO-20-004 v1.1–General Requirements for an FSC Training program

6 GENERAL

- 6.1 All FSC training providers need to be approved by ASI to assure adherence to the requirements of FSC-PRO-20-004 v1.1 and FSC-STD-20-001 v4.0.
- 6.2 Only training providers registered with ASI are eligible for providing training to FSC auditor candidates and FSC auditors.
- 6.3 The successful registration requires initial approval and monitoring processes for which ASI assessment procedures apply. The assessment criteria shall be the relevant FSC standards and procedures for training programs cited above (see clause 1.1).
- 6.4 Only those training courses which are approved and registered shall be considered as auditor training that meets the requirements for auditor qualification described in FSC-STD-20-001 v4.0 Annex 2 (clause 1.1 section 3 and clause 2.1 section 3).

7 REGISTRATION AND INITIAL EVALUATION OF THE TRAINING PROGRAM

- 7.1 All FSC training providers need to be registered with ASI.
 - 7.1.1 Accredited/approved CAB training providers are already registered via the Accreditation/Approval account. However, the CAB training programs shall be approved and individually registered in the ASI portal.
 - 7.1.2 Non-CAB training providers shall apply and be successfully registered with ASI following a formal application process. A service agreement between ASI and the non-CAB training provider shall be signed. After successful application, an ASI portal profile will be created and access to the ASI portal will be given to the applicant training provider.
 - 7.1.3 The training provider shall register all trainers / resources in the ASI portal and fill in all mandatory fields in the registry. Data shall be kept up-to-date.
- 7.2 The initial approval process consists of two assessment types which may be conducted together or separately:

- 7.2.1 Evaluation of management and administrative requirements in accordance with FSC-PRO-20-004, part I section 2, to verify:
 - 7.2.1.1 Written procedures;
 - 7.2.1.2 Record keeping procedures;
 - 7.2.1.3 Training scopes and contents;
 - 7.2.1.4 Appointed trainer or trainer team;
 - 7.2.1.5 Qualification of trainers;
 - 7.2.1.6 Training certificates;
 - 7.2.1.7 Confidentiality aspects;
 - 7.2.1.8 Procedures for handling changes to the FSC training program.
- 7.2.2 Witnessing of the training program, in line with ASI-PRO-20-111-Witness & Compliance Assessments.
 - 7.2.2.1 ASI will carry out a witness assessment of the training program to evaluate whether the requirements for the delivery of training according to FSC-PRO-20-004, part I, section 3 and part II are met.
 - 7.2.2.2 The estimated assessment time for the witness assessment depends on the scope of the training program and follows the duration of the entire course as outlined in the FSC-PRO-20-004. ASI witnesses the entire training course.
 - 7.2.2.3 Findings, if any, will be issued in line with ASI-PRO-20-106-Assessment Findings Procedure.
- 7.2.3 After a 5-year cycle, a full re-evaluation will be done by ASI.
- 7.2.4 FSC training courses that have been approved within the previous 2 years prior to the publication of this procedure shall be reviewed for compliance with the FSC-PRO-20-004. A witness audit may be waived if no significant changes have occurred.
- 7.2.5 A list of approved training providers will be made available on the ASI website.

8 ANNUAL SURVEILLANCE OF THE TRAINING PROGRAM

- 8.1 ASI will conduct an annual surveillance assessment to evaluate the continued conformance of the training provider with FSC requirements. The annual surveillance also aims to verify changes in the training program and how this is kept up to date with the changes in requirements. For FSC accredited/approved CABs, this may be part of the annual office assessment.
- 8.2 Assessments may be conducted onsite, as a desk review or remotely, depending on relevant risk factors and other considerations as per ASI-PRO-20-105-Surveillance & Sampling Procedure.

9 ASI FEES

- 9.1 For all assessment costs, ASI-INF-20-124-Fee schedule applies.
- 9.2 For non-accredited/approved entities, an initial registration fee of 500 € applies.

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